



Speed up Your Cloud with **MEMCACHED**

Is your website running into performance bottlenecks? Does the database or back-end feel like a really expensive resource, even though you've got a huge cluster set up to improve parallel processing? Read on to find out why you should be including Memcached, a distributed cache, in your cloud-based application.

Caching is a concept that almost all developers use in some form or the other in their applications. It's basically about storing a piece of information in memory so that it can be retrieved quickly, later, thus speeding up your application. Caching is mostly used for data that is accessed repeatedly, so that instead of calculating/retrieving from the disk repeatedly, which takes time, we can instead directly look it up in the cache, which is much faster. In the context of Web applications, for example, a dynamic

Web page can be cached on the server, so that we do not need to generate it again when a new request comes, provided the dynamic data present in the page hasn't changed within that time. That is the easy part, but caches can be used at multiple places in the application stack, so you have quite a few options when it comes to choosing where to cache, what to cache and how to cache. Without getting into too much jargon, here are some of the techniques on how and where you might like to cache data: